

Make Your Android Smartphone Work For You!

In recent years, there has been phenomenal growth in the use of smartphones. With the increasing popularity of the Android platform, the open source community has been taking a special interest in the smartphone domain. This article lets you know about some of the best applications available on the Android platform—for businessmen and those who want to get their work done on the go.

With more and more people taking an interest in Android and the increasing number of developers who post their apps on the Android Store, one is faced with some serious questions: How do we really choose from such a big collection of apps? How do we know which apps to install to make our phone faster, efficient and, more importantly, smarter? There are several questions going through a new Android device user's mind. Sometimes, even if you have been using your Android device for a long time, you might not be aware of some good apps. In this article, I will discuss the different apps that will make your phone smarter in a very practical way.

Browsing the Internet?

Many developers have come together to create Internet browsers made specifically for the Android platform. Here's a nifty browser that will take you by surprise. Named after the friendliest mammal known to humans, the *Dolphin* browser has proved to be extremely efficient and fast at its work. Its voice search feature, codenamed Sonar, allows you to effectively communicate in a way you would with that friendly mammal. The voice integration is so good that you can literally surf without typing anything at all. With simple voice commands, you can open a new tab, close tabs, navigate forward and back, or even zoom in or out of a Web page. If you're not a fan of voice commands and prefer the feathery touch on your phone, you can use its smart swipe feature called Gesture. Figure 1 shows the gesture for opening the Web page for Google when on a new tab. In fact, Dolphin is such an awesome browser, that it can do anything for you with the exception of making your coffee and doing your laundry.

The Dolphin also has a bunch of other cool features that make it function just like a desktop browser. In fact, it looks very similar to Chrome, IE or Firefox. So you do not have to spend extra time trying to learn the ins and outs of Dolphin. You can open multiple tabs on the browser and seamlessly navigate through them with a single touch. This feature actually saves a lot of time because in some other Android browsers, you have to

tap an icon, which gives you a list of open tabs, and then select the tab you want to view.

Dolphin gives you immediate access to any information you want. Just type or audibly mention the information you want and the browser fetches results directly from Twitter, Facebook, Amazon, YouTube and Wikipedia.

Dolphin has a number of other features that you can find out either by exploring on your own or simply looking it up on the Internet. Besides Dolphin, there are a few other browsers that have been specially designed for Android, such as UC Browser, Puffin, Maxthon Android, ONE Browser and Boat Browser. These function more or less in a similar manner to Chrome, Opera and Firefox.

